

LONGFOR GROUP (0960.HK)

1H26 Preview: DP margin weakness persists despite IP growth and on-track deleveraging; Neutral

We update our estimates to reflect **1)** substantial underperformance of contract sales in 1H26 (-53% yoy vs. average mid-teens % yoy decline by coverage DPs and top-100 developers), likely caused by adverse saleable setup and nearly-muted landbank replenishment. We therefore lower our 2026E contract sales target by 28% to Rmb26bn, implying -42% yoy and 35% sell-through (refreshing historical low) to be achieved against the Rmb105bn saleables budgeted for 2026, and lower 27E-28E contract sales by average 27%. We correspondingly lower the DP topline by average 14% across 26E-28E; **2)** we cut 2026E GPM to -16%, seeing limited recovery room from the 2H25 trough due to persistent pricing pressure for non-core markets and “aged inventory” (~80% of Longfor’s saleable resources by 2025). We likewise expanded JV loss to reflect similarly exacerbating profitability pressure; **3)** we also lowered PM and related services growth to 2% p.a. for 2026E-28E (vs. prior 7%), reflecting weakened delivery volume outlook and more competitive third-party biddings (increasingly dominated by SOE PMs). As result, we lower our bottomline estimates to Rmb2.4bn net loss in 2026E (vs. prior Rmb471mn net loss), and expect Rmb1.1bn/2.2bn net profits for 2027E-28E (vs. prior Rmb2.2bn/3.3bn). Our revised topline is 11% below Datastream consensus, while our core earnings forecast is substantially lower than consensus (vs. positive profits in 2026E per consensus and average ~60% lower than consensus for 2027E-28E) mainly on less constructive outlook on DP profitability. We lower our 12-month NAV-based target price by 14% to HK\$7.5 (still at a 25% NAV discount). Maintain Neutral.

- **1H operating data still under pressure: 1) DP:** Longfor’s 1H26 contract sales declined 53% yoy to Rmb17bn (vs. Rmb100bn budgeted for the whole year), below coverage average of down 15%. In addition, we note Longfor’s 1H26 land investment remained muted, vs. our tracked SOE developers’ spent average mid-twenties % of their contract sales in landbanking. Given the deleveraging plan, vintage inventory stock and prolonged property market downcycle, we expect Longfor to unlikely resume land acquisition until late next year. **2) Rental income:** rental income grew 4% yoy in 1H26, vs. peer CR Land +13% and Seazen +2% yoy, likely dragged by low-occupancy and unfavorable rent reversion of Longfor’s long-term rental apartment assets, while we expect rental income from Longfor’s malls could be growing at HSD% level on the back of enhanced operation and post-renovation SSSG recovery.

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- **Our view on 1H26:** we expect minor core net loss in 1H26, reflecting **(-)** double-digit DP topline contraction yoy, aligning with the broader industry trend and approx. 2pp-3pp yoy DP GPM decline from FY25 level given continued property price weakness of vintage inventories, especially those located outside top-tier cities, which might be largely buffered by **(+)** LSD% topline and profit growth of non-DP segments, mainly supported by mall income ramp-up, though we expect growth of long-term rental apartment and property service legs might be overshadowed by macro adversities and intensified scale expansion competition. Furthermore, we expect the company's debt reduction pace to be on track of achieving Rmb10bn p.a. in 26E-28E (vs. Rmb20bn achieved in average 23A-25A), with N-T repayment needs (Rmb2.3bn scheduled for rest of 2026E) likely well covered by rental-supported OCF.
- **Keys to watch next:** **1)** For upcoming 1H26 earnings - management guidance on potential inventory impairment and profitability impacts, rental income growth strength, net profit inflection timeline, etc. **2)** the progress of vintage inventory clearance through ordinary project sell-throughs, and rezoning or swapping of acquired lands with government, and whether land acquisition would resume to replenish landbank with higher-quality, better margin plots to drive future contract sales recovery. **3)** social retail sales trends and whether Longfor's GMV could continuously outperform that and lead to rental growth upside. **4)** debt reduction and restructuring pace (e.g. swapping high-interest financing with low-cost IP operating loans); **5)** other policy catalysts which could boost the employment outlook, consumer confidence or support the property market from the supply-side.

Valuation: Longfor trades at a 32% discount to end-26E NAV, 0.3X 2026E P/B vs. coverage average 34%/0.5X. Retain Neutral.

Key risks: 1) Above- or below-policy execution on supply-side liquidity support and demand-side easing; 2) Better-/weaker-than-expected deleveraging plan execution leading to stronger/weaker liquidity conditions; 3) Stronger/weaker-than-expected sell-through; 4) Better-/weaker-than-expected margin especially for old-vintage projects acquired before the current downturn; 5) Above-/below-expectation rental growth.

0960.HK		12m Price Target: HK\$7.5		Price: HK\$6.79		Upside: 10.5%	
Neutral		GS Forecast					
			12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E	
Market cap: HK\$35.1bn / \$4.5bn	Revenue (Rmb mn) New		97,308.6	75,125.5	71,845.0	67,268.5	
Enterprise value: HK\$244.7bn / \$31.2bn	Revenue (Rmb mn) Old		97,308.6	82,205.2	79,673.4	76,627.3	
3m ADTV :HK\$164.3mn/ \$21.0mn	EBITDA (Rmb mn)		6,926.0	415.4	6,283.6	8,562.6	
China	EPS (Rmb) New		(0.24)	(0.34)	0.15	0.30	
China Property	EPS (Rmb) Old		(0.24)	(0.07)	0.31	0.47	
	P/E (X)		NM	NM	38.0	19.2	
M&A Rank: 3	P/B (X)		0.4	0.3	0.3	0.3	
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: No	Dividend yield (%)		0.8	0.0	0.8	1.6	
	CROCI (%)		NM	0.1	0.7	1.1	
			12/25	6/26E	12/26E	6/27E	
	EPS (Rmb)		(0.44)	(0.03)	(0.31)	0.06	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 16 Jul 2026 close.

Price Target Risks & Methodology

Our 12m end-26E NAV-based target price is HK\$7.5, based on a 25% discount to end-25E NAV.

Key risks:

1) Above- or below-policy execution on supply-side liquidity support and demand-side easing; 2) Better-/weaker-than-expected deleveraging plan execution leading to stronger/weaker liquidity conditions; 3) Stronger/weaker-than-expected sell-through; 4) Better-/weaker-than-expected margin especially for old-vintage projects acquired before the current downturn; 5) Above-/below-expectation rental growth.

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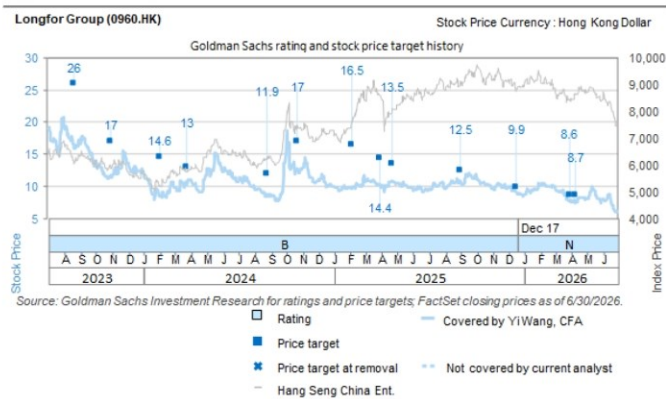
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Longfor Group (0960.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
09-Apr-26	8.70	7.43
30-Mar-26	8.60	7.69
17-Dec-25	9.90	9.07
01-Sep-25	12.50	10.83
22-Apr-25	13.50	10.84
31-Mar-25	14.40	9.81
06-Feb-25	16.50	9.80
22-Oct-24	17.00	12.54
26-Aug-24	11.90	8.75
25-Mar-24	13.00	10.66
02-Feb-24	14.60	8.70
31-Oct-23	17.00	11.38
21-Aug-23	26.00	15.98

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